

## 2. SATELLITES

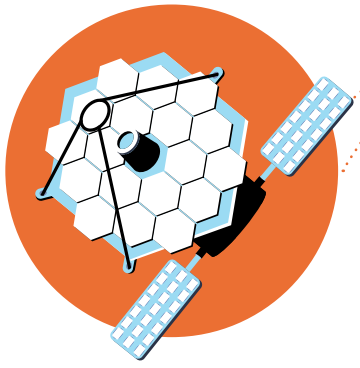
- Earth observation
- Scientific missions





## 3. SUBSYSTEMS

- Propulsion | Avionics
- Power | Bellatrix | Manastu
- XDLINX, etc.



## 4. GROUND INFRASTRUCTURE

- Ground stations | Mission operations | Tracking | Launch integration | Data downlink
- Dhruva | Astrome, etc.

## 5. APPLICATIONS

- Agriculture | Defence

**IN MAY 2020, FM NIRMALA SITHARAMAN ANNOUNCED STIMULUS MEASURES FOR THE CREATION OF IN-SPACE**

ILLUSTRATIONS BY **RAJ VERMA**



founder and CEO Pawan Kumar Chandana told a television channel after the launch. "The next phase is to reliably reach orbit... and then get to commercialisation." Chandana didn't respond to *BT*'s emails and messages requesting comments for this story.

In Bengaluru, Yashas Karanam, Co-founder and COO of Bellatrix Aerospace, was watching the launch at his office, with a team member running live commentary over the feed.

"We were all super excited, wishing that it would be a success, because it sends out a very strong signal to the global ecosystem that India means serious business," says Karanam. "Having a launch vehicle succeed on the first attempt, at full scale... a lot of countries have actually failed to do that."

When Vikram-1 reached low-Earth orbit on its maiden flight, it became the first privately developed Indian orbital launch vehicle to fly from Indian soil. It also made India the third country, after the US and China, with private orbital launch capability. Germany joined them on September 5, when Isar Aerospace put its Spectrum rocket into orbit from Andøya Spaceport in Arctic Norway. It was proof that India's private space industry, which was in the making for decades but opened up for private participa-